

Examiner reports

Q1.

There were few problems in part (a) apart from those candidates who were unable to make the connection between the number of minutes past 8.00am and the actual time. Even these candidates generally recovered in part (b), which was answered well. Part (c) was often omitted. Many of those who attempted it seemed to be looking for a more complex answer than the one expected. Despite the italicised warning in part (d), many candidates made general points instead of relating their answers to the data given in the question.

Q2.

A surprisingly large proportion of candidates were unable to carry out the calculation in part (b). It was rare for candidates who failed at this stage to score many marks later in the question.

Q3.

Again most candidates were able to make a good start on this question.

Q4.

Many candidates scored high marks and there were no problems.

Q5.

Part (a) was well answered. In part (b), a substantial number of candidates worked backwards from Table 3. This is more difficult and likely to be less accurate (even if interpolation is used) than using Table 4. There were surprisingly few correct answers to part (b), with the majority of candidates adding (instead of subtracting) 1.2816σ to the mean.

Q6.

Part (a) was well answered but part (b) was not. A common error was to confuse the standard deviation with the variance but many omitted this part completely. Part (c)(i) provided two easy marks for those candidates who used their calculators, but many candidates carried out lengthy and often incorrect calculations.

In part (c)(ii), many candidates ignored the instruction to relate the answer to part (c)(i) and answered in general terms instead. It was common for candidates to interpret the data in part (c) as the number of minutes Siballi had to wait for a bus rather than the number of times out of ten Siballi had to wait more than 6 minutes.

Q7.

This question was generally well answered.

Q8.

This question was well answered with part (a) causing fewer problems than similar past

questions. This may have been due to the correct z-value being positive rather than negative.

